

Ravindu Nawanjana

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WORK EXPERIENCE

Country Representative - World Food Forum Rome, Italy
Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations July 2025 - Present

Country Representative - Sustainable Energy Transition London, United Kingdom
The Commonwealth July 2025 - Present

Head Of Impact Investments and Sustainability Colombo, Sri Lanka
Kangara Holdings Pvt Ltd September 2024 - Present

- Assisting in developing Sri Lanka's proposed first large-scale carbon credit reforestation and agriculture projects spanning 100,000 – 200,000 hectares, with a combined carbon credit revenue generation worth over \$364 - \$450 million per annum at maturity, to be scaled in September of 2027. The project will start with two initial 6,000 hectare projects, generating over \$12 million in carbon credit revenue annually to be launched in April and September of 2026.
- Working within a cross-functional team of 12 research, human resources, and legal professionals to draft agreements with community groups and secure project buy-in.
- Spearheading and managing an \$8 million portfolio including impact investments in the UAE, the Maldives, Oman, Malaysia, and Sri Lanka with a projected annual growth rate of over 18%.
- Managing project documentation, compliance, and end-to-end project management for initiatives within Sri Lanka.
- Serving as a key private sector liaison and actively pursuing grant funding applications totaling \$21 million from Multilateral Development Banks, including the Climate Investment Fund (World Bank Group).
- Implementing rigorous internal financial controls, risk management protocols and innovative ESG integration strategies, resulting in improved capital allocation efficiency, an 18% reduction in operational costs, and a 15% improvement in sustainability metrics across the group portfolio.

Independent Financial Consultant Colombo, Sri Lanka
September 2023 - Present

- Conducting in-depth market research in the USA, UK, UAE, and Sri Lanka to identify high-return opportunities for clients including forex, energy systems, vertical farming, and green/social/blue bonds.
- Achieving an average monthly portfolio gain of 21%.

WILDLIFE CONSERVATION STARTUP

Founder Colombo, Sri Lanka
CuteFela September 2023 - Present

- Started a Sri Lankan Wildlife Conservation Startup, registered under Certificate No.WU18393, to encourage private sector investment in wildlife conservation and animal protection whilst obtaining a measurable return on these investments.
- Initiated over 15 projects to restore protected wildlife sanctuaries, animal shelters, and develop disaster response projects in collaboration with Government stakeholders.
- Collaborated with the Ministry of Wildlife Conservation and Forest Resources Conservation, and the Department of Zoological Gardens, to assist in developing and delivering workshops and

other educational activities in 19 national parks, 02 national zoos, an elephant orphanage and a safari park for students and the public.

- Raised funds for wildlife restoration projects by starting an environmentally friendly apparel business directing 80% of the profit gained to these projects.
- Produced high-end clothing promoting wildlife awareness, incorporating dyes made from charcoal and mahogany and fabrics made from plastic and other recycled materials.

UN CONVENTION DELEGATE

UNFCCC COP28 in Dubai, UAE, 2023, UNFCCC COP29 in Baku, Azerbaijan, 2024

UNCCD COP16 in Riyadh, Saudi Arabia, 2024

- Registered CuteFela startup as a Business and Industry Entity for the UNCCD COP16.

UNFCCC COP30 in Belem, Brazil, 2025

EDUCATION

LONDON METROPOLITAN UNIVERSITY

MSc International Banking and Finance

London, United Kingdom

Expected September 2026

LONDON METROPOLITAN UNIVERSITY

BSc (Hons) in Banking and Finance

London, United Kingdom

August 2025

COLOMBO STOCK EXCHANGE

Advanced Diploma in Financial Markets

Colombo, Sri Lanka

June 2024

CERTIFICATIONS

World Bank, United Nations Institute for Training and Research (UNITAR)

Carbon Taxation

April 2025

Partnership for Action on Green Economy (PAGE), United Nations

Green Industrial Policy - Promoting Competitiveness and Structural Transformation

April 2025

PUBLICATIONS

The Role of Stock Exchanges in Promoting the Banking Sector in Adopting Green Finance:

A Global Analysis with Insights from Emerging Markets (December 2025). ISSN 3051-5874

The Role of Multilateral Climate Funds in Shaping the Architecture of Climate Finance:

An Analysis of Blended Finance and Institutional Collaboration among MDBs, Central Banks, and Private Capital across the G77 and China (Expected: June 2026)

CORE COMPETENCIES

Business Development, Strategic Partnership Development, Project Management, Funding Applications, ESG Compliance (GRI, SASB, CDP, TCFD, SBTi), DCF, Excel, Green Finance, Government Liaison

INTERESTS

Basketball- Captained the college team to the national finals (2023); currently part of club basketball.

Theatre- Distinction in Music Theory (UWL, 2022); performed lead roles in multiple productions.

Leadership- Served as Lance Corporal in the college Army Cadet platoon and led the debating unit.

LANGUAGES

Fluent in English and Sinhala.